

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Miss Layla QURESHI

Address: 42 Marlow Drive North Cheam SM3 9AZ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing in support of the planning application for the proposed Islamic and Community Centre.

I am a 28 year old local resident, born and raised in Sutton. I attended nursery, primary school, and secondary school here, and Sutton has always been my home. I am a local resident who cares deeply about our area and its future. I genuinely believe that our community would greatly benefit from and is in real need of this centre.

The proposed centre would provide a safe, welcoming space for people of all ages from young children to the elderly. It would offer youth programmes, wellbeing initiatives, women's support services, and educational activities that would be open and accessible to the wider community. These kinds of structured activities are invaluable in fostering positive engagement, personal development, and social connection.

Importantly, the centre would help reduce isolation and loneliness by creating opportunities for people to come together, interact, and support one another. In a time when many people feel disconnected, spaces like this strengthen community bonds and promote understanding across different backgrounds.

I understand that some residents have concerns about traffic. However, prayer times do not coincide with school drop-off and pick-up times. Friday prayer times would also be staggered specifically to avoid conflict with school collection hours. Additionally, the local Muslim community has been hiring St John's Community Hall, located just down the road from the ambulance station,

every Friday afternoon and every evening during Ramadan for the past five years. I personally attend St John's Hall for prayers at the moment. This arrangement has not caused significant disruption, and therefore the proposed change of use is unlikely to create a noticeable difference in traffic levels.

The site will provide 12 on-site parking spaces, including 2 disabled bays, as well as bicycle racks, encouraging sustainable travel. The centre is intended to be low-intensity, with no significant light or noise disturbance. The existing greenery will be maintained, ensuring the character of the area is preserved.

Overall, I strongly believe that converting the former ambulance station into a Community Centre would be a positive and meaningful addition to Sutton. It would serve not only the Muslim community but the wider local community as well, providing support, education, wellbeing initiatives, and a safe space for connection.

I respectfully ask that the application be approved.

Thank you for your consideration.